

About this book

It's easy to find what you're looking for in **The DK Picture Encyclopedia**. The large heading of each main entry tells you what the page is about. Subjects are arranged alphabetically to help you quickly look up subjects that interest you.

Index

If you can't find the topic you are looking for, it may not be a main entry. Look it up in the index to find out which page it is on.

Main entries

There are 145 exciting main entries to look up and learn about.

Alphabet

Use the alphabet at the top of the page to help you find your place in the encyclopedia.

Index

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North America

US and Mexico

With mountains in the west and east, deserts in the south, North America has some spectacular scenery.

Rocky Mountains

The Rockies stretch for 3,000 miles (4,800 km) down the western side of the US.

Monument

These sandstone rocks have been carved in the desert.

Death Valley

Death Valley in California is the hottest, driest place in the whole of North America.

Sonoran Desert

This desert lies between the US and Mexico. It is famous for its giant cacti.

Collared lizard

This lizard manages to survive in the dry deserts.

Grand Canyon

This deep, rocky gorge has been cut out in Arizona by the Colorado River.

Okefenokee Swamp

This freshwater swamp in southern Georgia is a safe refuge for wildlife.

Everglades

This vast tropical marsh in Florida is home to animals such as alligators.

Find out more

Desert animals 45

Water 146

Insects

They crawl, fly, buzz, and sting – insects may be small, but there are over a million kinds, more than any other animal in the world.

Types of insects

Damselflies are expert fliers and dart through the air.

Beetles have hard wing cases to protect their delicate wings.

Flies have two wings that beat so fast they buzz.

Butterflies and moths have four patterned wings.

Growing up

Many insects change shape as they grow. This is called metamorphosis.

Ladybug

1 A wormlike larva hatches from an egg. It feeds and grows.

Larva

2 The fully grown larva makes a hard case called a pupa around itself.

Pupa

3 About a week later, the pupa splits open, and an adult ladybug crawls out.

Did you know?

The South American grasshopper disguises itself as a thin twig.

Ant colonies

Ants live in groups called colonies and share all the work to be done.

Wasp

All insects have three sections to their bodies and six legs – just like this wasp.

Antennae are feelers that taste and smell the air.

Eyes

Tiny claws can hang on to plants.

The head is the first part of the body.

The thorax is the middle part of the body.

The abdomen is the end part of the body.

The six legs bend at the joints.

Wings

Find out more

Butterflies and moths 36

Insects of the world 87

“Did you know?”

Every page has a “Did you know?” box with a fascinating fact about the subject for you to discover.

Exciting photographs

Each page is full of colorful close-up photographs, and many feature step-by-step sequences.

Picture cross-references

At the bottom of each page, you will find out where to look for more information on related subjects.

Illustrated maps

Large picture maps on many pages help you learn about different parts of the world.

Subentries

Every page has several subentries giving you more information about the main subject. You can find these by using the index.